

Tone - Workbook 3

Focused practice - Workbook 3 of 3

How to use this workbook

Read each short text closely. Answer without checking the key. Then compare your reasoning with the explanation and mark the mistake type if you were wrong.

Before you start

- Underline or mentally mark the exact wording that controls your answer.
- Do not choose an option just because it is true in general; it must fit this text.
- After checking, write one sentence explaining why the strongest wrong answer fails.

Neighborhood Column

The columnist writes, "Another glossy rendering will not fix a broken sidewalk."

1. Which tone is most likely?

- A. critical
- B. grateful
- C. uncertain
- D. nostalgic

2. Which word contributes most to that tone?

- A. another
- B. glossy
- C. sidewalk
- D. fix

Retirement Note

"For thirty years, Mei remembered everyone's deadline and somehow everyone's birthday too," the team wrote.

3. What tone does the sentence create?

- A. warm and appreciative
- B. resentful
- C. formal and distant
- D. fearful

4. Why does somehow help the tone?

- A. It adds gentle admiration for Mei's remarkable attentiveness.
- B. It suggests the team distrusts Mei.
- C. It proves nobody had calendars.
- D. It makes the sentence angry.

Project Update

"We are behind schedule, but the hardest uncertainty is now resolved," the engineer writes.

5. Which tone is most accurate?

- A. realistic but hopeful
- B. carefree
- C. mocking
- D. despairing

6. Which structure helps create that tone?

- A. the contrast introduced by but
- B. the word engineer
- C. the comma alone
- D. the absence of numbers

Answer key and reasoning

Neighborhood Column

1. A. The writer dismisses presentations that do not solve a practical problem.
2. B. Glossy suggests surface-level appearance and carries criticism in this context.

Retirement Note

3. A. The specific affectionate detail about birthdays conveys warmth and appreciation.
4. A. Somehow conveys impressed affection rather than a dry factual record.

Project Update

5. A. The writer acknowledges a problem while emphasizing meaningful progress.
6. A. The contrast balances the negative fact with a positive development.

Mistake review

- If you chose a familiar meaning that did not fit the context, label it wrong sense.
- If you chose an option based on one word but ignored the rest of the passage, label it one-clue trap.
- If you understood the basic meaning but missed attitude or effect, label it effect missed.
- Redo the question later without looking at the key.